Simple past et present perfect

Le simple past (prétérit)

Action terminée, à un moment précis du passé.

- Forme : verbe + -ed (worked, played) ou forme irrégulière (go → went, see → saw, eat → ate).
- Négation et question avec did + base verbale : I didn't go. Did you see him?
- Mots repères : yesterday, last week, last year, in 2020, two days ago, when I was young.
  I visited Grand-Bassam last year.

Le present perfect

Action passée qui a un lien avec le présent.

- Forme : have / has + participe passé (worked, gone, seen, eaten, written, been).
- Il sert pour :
  - une expérience : Have you ever eaten attiéké? I have never been to Ghana.
  - un résultat présent : She has lost her key (elle ne l'a toujours pas).
  - une action qui dure jusqu'à maintenant : We have lived in Abidjan since 2015.
- Mots repères : ever, never, just, already, yet, since, for.

Since ou for ?

- since + point de départ : since 2015, since Monday, since I was ten.
- for + durée : for ten years, for two hours.

Comparer

- I saw this film yesterday. (moment précis → simple past)
- I have seen this film. (expérience, sans date → present perfect)

On ne dit jamais « I have seen this film yesterday ».

Verbes irréguliers à connaître

be – was/were – been · go – went – gone · see – saw – seen · eat – ate – eaten · write – wrote – written · take – took – taken · come – came – come · give – gave – given

Pièges à éviter

- Après did, la base verbale : I didn't go (et non didn't went).
- Ago va avec le simple past : I arrived two days ago.

Teste-toi

1. My father has worked at the port ___ ten years.

A. ago
B. for
C. during
D. since

2. I have known Awa ___ 2020.

A. for
B. since
C. ago
D. during

3. Have you ever ___ attiéké?

A. eating
B. eat
C. ate
D. eaten

4. They ___ the match two days ago.

A. watch
B. watched
C. has watched
D. have watched

Corrigé

1. B : For + durée (ten years). Since + point de départ.
2. B : 2020 est un point de départ : since.
3. D : Present perfect : have + participe passé. eat – ate – eaten.
4. B : « Ago » indique un moment précis du passé : simple past.